

Three clients: Chat, Cowork, and Code — and how you reach them

Claude Certified Developer, Foundation (CCDV-F) · UST masterclass

EN Session 2 of 12 · English notes

Vijay restated the product set as **three client applications**—Chat, Cowork, and Code—plus, when you leave the GUI, the **Claude API and SDK** (a token from the console, not “the fourth tile”). Getting the access map wrong is how people fail both the exam and the UST laptop build: Cowork is not on the web the way Chat is; Code is not only an IDE plugin.

The three GUI clients

Client	Job in one sentence	Web	Desktop app	CLI	IDE integration (VS Code, IntelliJ, Visual Studio, ...)
Chat	Conversational assistant; answers stay in the thread	Yes — primary	Yes (Chat pane)	No	Often Chat-like side panel together with Code
Cowork	Agentic local workspace: folders, multi-step tasks, schedule / mobile trigger	Not the access path he taught	Yes — and only here in class (latest desktop)	No	No — he was explicit: you cannot use Cowork inside the IDE
Code	Agentic coding over a repo: edit, terminal, tests, git	Not the main path	Yes (Code surface)	Yes — Code only	Yes — Code (and often Chat)

Desktop, in a current enough build, is the only place he promised *all three*. He showed about **desktop 1.24** as the floor for Cowork in that week’s demo; anything like 1.10 needed an upgrade. If Cowork is still missing after upgrade, it is an **org policy** (Rajesh confirmed UST had blocked Cowork for some users; IT later said R&D accounts inside allocated VDI/workspace could have it). Cowork had only been generally available on the order of a month; vulnerability review is a rational delay, not a product myth.

VERSION AND POLICY DRIFT

Build numbers and which tiles your tenant shows will not match 5 August 2026. Confirm on [Claude support / desktop notes](#) and your admin, not this table’s version cell.

Fourth and fifth paths: API and “everywhere else”

To use the **Claude SDK** (Python, Node, ...) you need a console account and an **API key**. That key is not Chat login. Billing and rate limits for API are a separate plane from the Chat five-hour usage bar (he said so explicitly when discussing meters). Integrations named in week 1—Chrome, Excel, PowerPoint, Microsoft 365, Slack—are additional clients, not replacements for the three.

Who each client is for in UST language

- **Chat:** everyone. Architects summarising an SRS still start here if they do not need disk writes.

- **Cowork:** knowledge workers and anyone with local PDFs/CSV/PPT who needs the files *changed*. Also the place Vijay put scheduled jobs and “trigger from the phone.”
- **Code:** CCDV-F centre of gravity. Full-stack, backend, AI engineers. Assistants used to complete a line; this agent can plan a repo, run tests, open PRs, talk to Jira/Figma via tools.

Why Chat versus Cowork still confuses people

You can upload a PPT to Chat and ask for a summary. Cowork’s difference is **the attached folder is a workspace the agent may create, move, edit, and delete in**, with a consent banner (edit / delete / share with connected tools). Chat will not silently tidy your Downloads folder. If the exam stem says “reorganise invoices on disk,” the answer is Cowork (or Code/SDK), not Chat.

Authentication plans

Claude Code install (next module) required Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise—not a random free consumer leftover. UST is on Team/Enterprise. API keys still come from the console and may be denied by org policy even when Chat works. Download Claude Code from the company software portal / private npm if that is how UST pins versions; Vijay’s curl/npm demo is the upstream method, not a bypass of security.

Exam sentence to memorise

All three are **clients**. Haiku/Sonnet/Opus are **servers**. Only Cowork and Code were labelled **agentic** in the 5 August recap (Chat can still call tools; he reserved “agentic solution” language for the products that run multi-step plans against local tools). If two answers both say “use Claude,” pick the client that matches disk, IDE, or conversation.

Official documentation

- **Claude Docs home**
<https://docs.claude.com/en/home>
 Current product surfaces when desktop tiles change.
- **Claude Code overview**
<https://code.claude.com/docs/en/overview>
 CLI and IDE install paths.
- **Cowork / Claude desktop support**
<https://support.claude.com/>
 Desktop distribution and feature availability.
- **API overview**
<https://docs.claude.com/en/api/overview>
 The non-GUI client: keys, Messages, separate limits.
- **Where is the API documentation?**
<https://support.claude.com/en/articles/8114490-where-can-i-find-your-api-documentation>
 If you only have claude.ai and need the console path.

Study notes distilled from the UST CCD Foundation masterclass. Prefer Anthropic's current docs over session anecdotes. Not official exam material.